

Aksharaa Bhobe

Chicago, IL | akshbhobe@gmail.com | +1 773-200-5464 | [linkedin.com/in/aksharaa-bhobe](https://www.linkedin.com/in/aksharaa-bhobe) | [Portfolio](#)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Consumer Insights, Research & Analytics professional with 2+ years of agency-side experience designing and executing qualitative and quantitative research across CPG, tech, beauty, and finance. Combines deep qualitative research craft with quantitative analytics and strategic problem-solving, translating consumer and market data into actionable recommendations. Experience includes segmentation, concept testing, thematic analysis, survey research, market sizing, and client-facing storytelling for global brands.

EDUCATION

MS, Integrated Marketing Communication

Northwestern University, Medill School of Journalism

Expected 2026

- GPA: 3.93/4.0 | Selected Grader, IMC 401 Consumer Insight

Postgraduate Diploma, Interdisciplinary Studies (FLAME Scholars)

FLAME University

2022–2023

- GPA: 8.47/10 | Academic Merit Scholarship

BBA, Communications Management

FLAME University

2019–2022

- Class Rank: 2/46 | Silver Medal | Dean's Roll of Honor, all semesters

EXPERIENCE

Consultant, Product Management & Brand Strategy

SWISSGEAR × Group III International

Jun 2026–Present

- Designed and fielded a psychographic survey across 2,400 participants; applied k-means segmentation to identify SWISSGEAR's right-to-play and right-to-win spaces within a ~\$19B U.S. core TAM.
- Built an 8-criteria whitespace framework across 7 concepts with 1/3/5-year SOM projections, surfacing a \$36M year-5 opportunity and a 4.58× willingness-to-pay premium among existing category owners.

Research Scholar

Northwestern Medill, Spiegel Research Center

Oct 2025–Present

- Selected as 1 of 6 scholars from a cohort of 120 to independently design and conduct original consumer research on sports fandom, belonging, and social connection.
- Conducted 14 semi-structured interviews across 10 countries and 4 continents; built a hierarchical thematic coding schema and translated findings into marketing implications.

Senior Research Associate

Clients: Mondelez, ITC Foods, Sprite, L'Oréal, Google, YouTube, Amazon, Bayer, Piramal, Vivo, Flipkart, Spotify, Cadbury Gems, Pantaloons

Third Eye Integrated Services

Apr 2024–Apr 2025

- Led end-to-end delivery of 20+ client-facing research studies across CPG, tech, beauty, and finance; managed field quality and guided junior Research Associates from recruitment through synthesis.
- Translated ambiguous client briefs into research proposals and feasible study designs, framing business questions into clear research objectives, methodologies, and execution plans under tight timelines.
- Developed a projective exercise for a global confectionery brand that uncovered "transmedia anxiety" as a defining consumer tension, shifting the brand's Valentine's strategy from grand gestures to small, relatable moments.
- Flagged strong target-segment rejection of a proposed beauty brand name during concept testing, prompting revision before launch; synthesized research into personas and journey maps that informed category entry and pricing strategy.

Research Associate

Third Eye Integrated Services

Aug 2023–Mar 2024

- Coordinated 13 research studies end-to-end; wrote 4 original recruitment questionnaires and adapted screening criteria for 5+ additional studies.
- Co-moderated qualitative sessions across in-person groups, survey-based research with children and mothers, and WhatsApp/Recollective digital diaries for clients including Spotify, Cadbury Gems, Google AI/Bard, and Pantaloons, leveraging AI to facilitate data visualization and unique analysis.

Earlier Experience

WageIndicator Foundation / Quantum Consumer Solutions

May 2021–Apr 2023

- Data Visualization & Business Analytics Intern:** analyzed labor law and minimum-wage data across 50+ countries and built 10+ Tableau visualizations.
- Market Research & Consumer Psychology Intern:** conducted qualitative research for YouTube including usage-and-attitudes research ahead of YouTube Shorts' India launch.

SKILLS

Quantitative & Analytics: Survey Design, Segmentation, K-means Clustering, SPSS, STATA, R, Excel, Tableau, Mintel, MRI-Simmons, SimplyAnalytics

Qualitative Research: In-depth Interviews, Thematic/Hierarchical Coding, Phenomenological Analysis, Projective Techniques, Ethnographic Immersions, Concept Testing, Personas, Journey Mapping

Research Platforms: Qualtrics, SurveySparrow, Recollective, BrandWatch, Mention | Languages: English, Hindi, Marathi, French

ATHLETICS

- National-level Competitive Powerlifter: Bronze, National Championship 2023; multiple state & regional gold medals